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PHILADELPHIA PLANNED GIVING DAY

Legacy Giving as the Catalyst in Fundraising Strategies



Gwen M. Paxon, CFRE
Vice President of Client Services





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YOUR PRESENTER

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“Planned giving is the bridge between one’s heart and one’s legacy, allowing one's values to shape the future long after they are gone”



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Why Legacy Giving Matters

- 33% of Americans are willing to consider a charitable bequest
- Average age of first bequest designation is 45-50
- The younger you reach a prospect, the better: You'll increase annual giving by 6x-7x
- Once a nonprofit is in the will, it is likely to remain by 75%
- 65% of donors who made a bequest notified the non-profit of their intention
- Individuals over the age of 55 control 80% of USA wealth
- 61% of households own equities in the USA

Sources: FreeWill 2022-2023, Planned Giving Report, Giving USA, Donor-Centered Planned Gift Marketing, Source: LinkedIn News 2024, Money.com, Rosenberg Research

Obstacles to Integration



What are some of the obstacles you have come across?

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Obstacles to Integration

- Competition for donors
- No buy in – limited knowledge
- Lack of philanthropic organizational culture
- Silos among departments
- Pressure for immediate gifts vs. legacy gifts



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Overcoming the Obstacles



Overcoming the Obstacles

- Discuss blended gifts and the fact that most legacy donors continue to give more once they have made a commitment
- Educate the team on legacy giving
- Encourage philanthropic culture
- Share information



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Opportunities for Integration

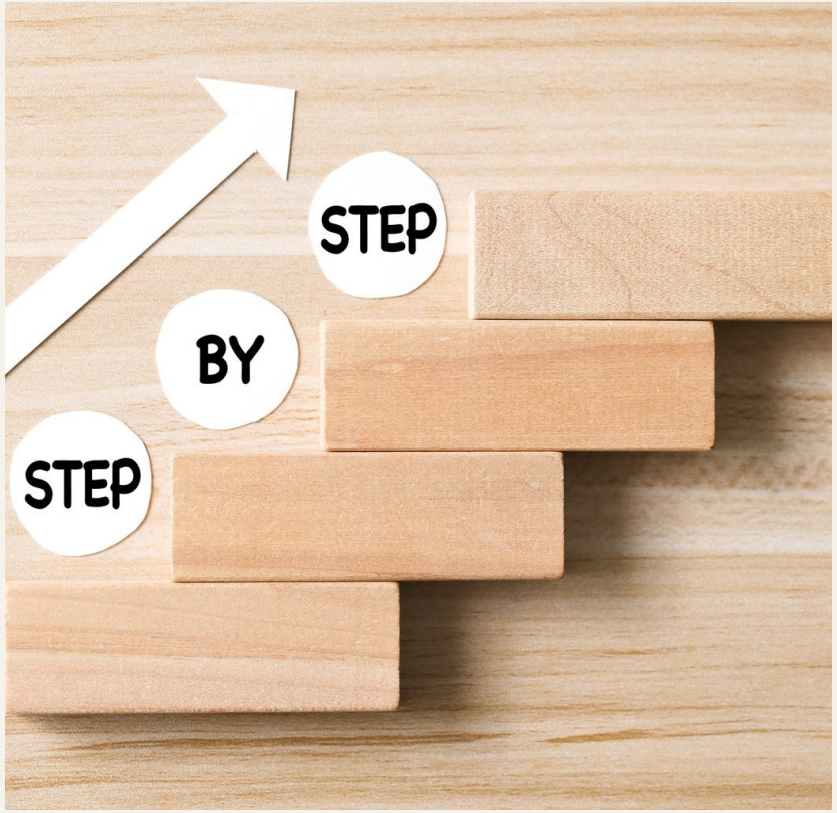
01 Annual Giving	02 Mid-Level Giving	03 Major Gifts/Campaign	04 Events	05 Volunteer Engagement
06 Donor Stewardship	07 Board Development	08 Marketing	09 CRM Management	10 Staff Training

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Before You Integrate

1. **Prepare the Goals for the Year**
2. **Planned Giving Case for Support**
3. **Prepare Multi-Channel Messaging**

- Social & Website
- E-Newsletter
- Magazine
- Events
- Testimonials



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Annual Giving Integration

- Check boxes on reply mechanisms – one for those who have included you and one for those who are interested in information
- Include bequest messaging in appeals
- Highlight stock gifts
- 5 x 10 to discuss donor's long-term goals



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Mid-Level Giving Integration

- Segment donors based on PG indicators – consecutive years of giving/age/lifetime gifts
- Share educational information on legacy gifts
- Host estate planning seminars
- 5 x 10 to discuss donor's long-term goals



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Major Gift Integration

- Discuss how donor's philanthropy can continue in perpetuity
- Include planned giving in major gift proposals
- Highlight blended gifts
- 5 x 10 to discuss donor's long-term goals
- Train major gift officers to identify opportunities for a legacy discussion



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Events Integration

- Special pin and recognition from the stage
- Legacy donors strategically placed at events
- Speakers highlighting why they made a legacy gift
- Lunch and learn seminars
- Planned Giving information tables
- QR code or nicely done postcard-size information card or on iPad



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Volunteer Integration

- Share why legacy gifts matter
- Introduce interested donors to development staff
- Serve as ambassadors
- Model philanthropy through their own commitments



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Stewardship Integration

- Recognition
- Special events
- Make them feel special
- Incorporate into the stewardship calendar
- Bequest awareness campaign



Board Integration

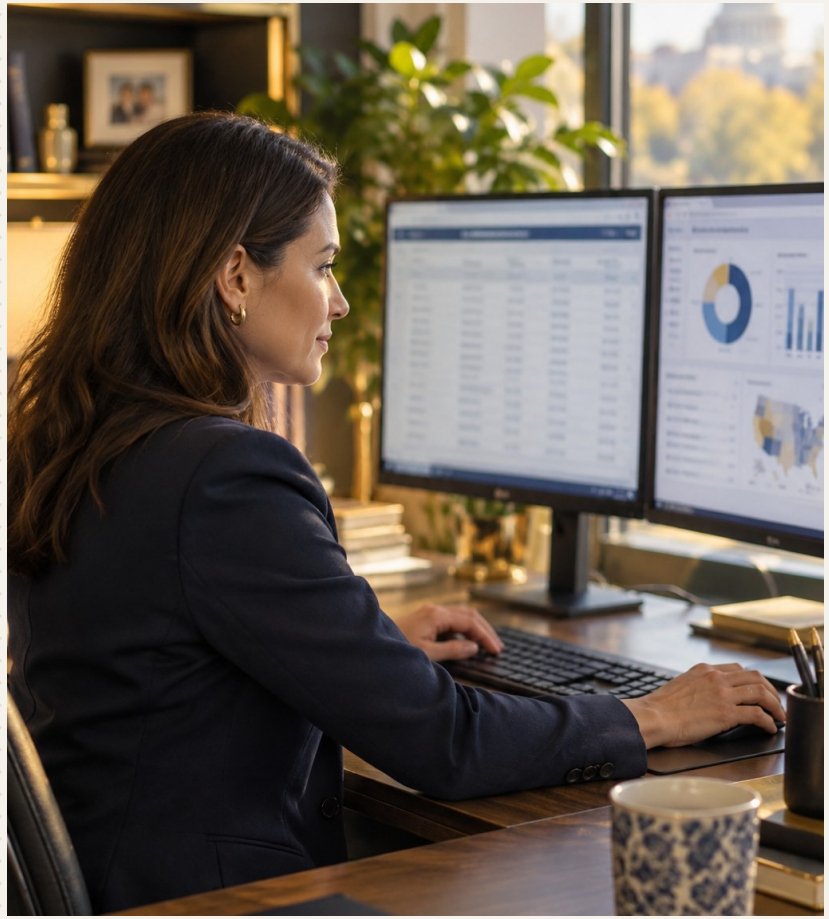
- Training – the what and the why
- Board participation
- Board requirement?
- Including in the strategic planning process
- Identify PG prospects and rate them on relationship
- Receive annual planned giving updates



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Marketing Integration

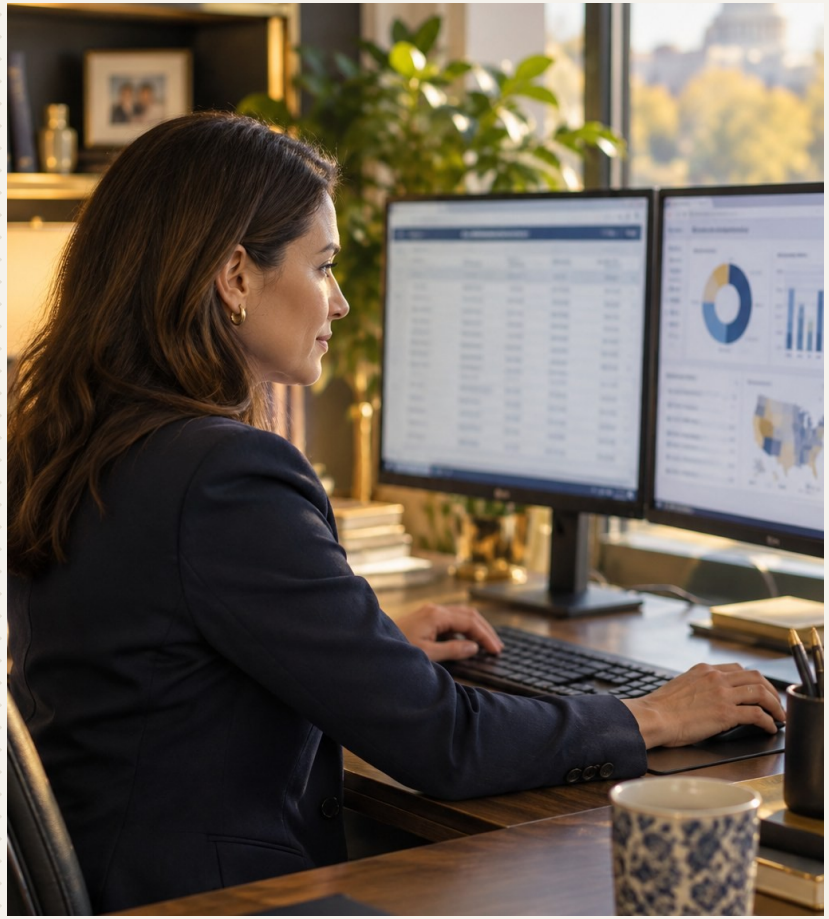
- Legacy Donor Stories – Social Media/Websites/Newsletters/Donor Communication
- Using digital voicemail as a tool
- Use consistent messaging
- Benefits of CGAs



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CRM Integration

- Ability to track PG touchpoints/expectancies
- Record Legacy Society Members
- Follow Up Dates and Advisor relationships
- Identify potential LS members through consecutive years of giving and engagement levels



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Staff Training Integration

- General PG Knowledge
- How to ask – Don't be afraid
- How to identify cues donors give about interest in a legacy gift
- Bank PODs, Beneficiary Designations
- Simple bequest – 80% of PGs





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Thousands of loyal donors are waiting to be asked

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Q&A – Thank you!

- **Capital Campaign Consulting**
- **Capacity Building**
- **Major Gift Initiatives**
- **Prospect Research**
- **Planned Giving Programs**
- **Mid-Level Donor Calling Programs**
- **Annual Fund Calling**
- **Campaign Wrap-Up Calling**
- **Planned Giving – Legacy Call Programs**

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